

“Not for lap times.
Not for headlines.
For data.”





F1 Driver Performance Analysis

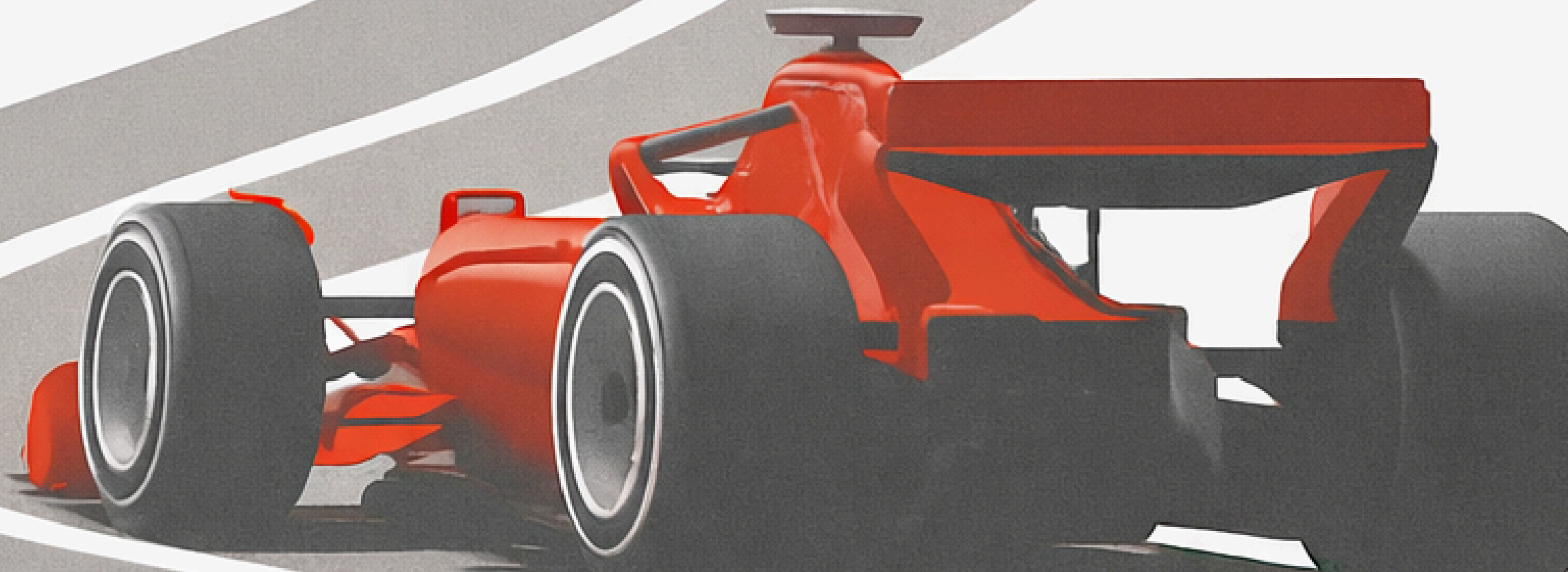
Team Principals

Carolyn Chang

Wendy Cheng

Iva Dhooria

Kandace Bui



Turn 1

Data & Purpose

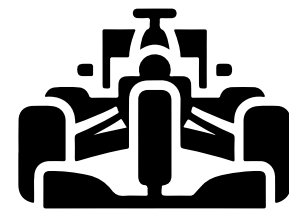


THE DATASET

“F1DriversDataset.csv”



F1 Drivers Career Statistics



1950 to 2023



868 Drivers



22 Variables



Data & Purpose

Exploration & Visualization

Preprocessing & Mining

Results & Insights

THE DATASET



“F1DriversDataset.csv”



Driver Info

Name

Nationality

Years_Active

Champion

Points



Performance Metrics

Race_Wins

Win_Rate

Podiums

Podium_Rate

Pole_Positions

Fastest_Laps

Race_Entries

Points_Per_Entry



Data & Purpose

Exploration & Visualization

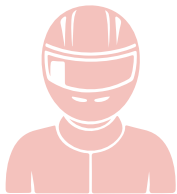
Preprocessing & Mining

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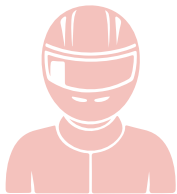
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PROJECT GOAL



**Which performance metrics
are most predictive of
Championship success**



Build predictive models to
evaluate driver potential



Smarter driver investment
decisions



Data & Purpose

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Data & Purpose

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Preprocessing & Mining

Results & Insights

Turn 2

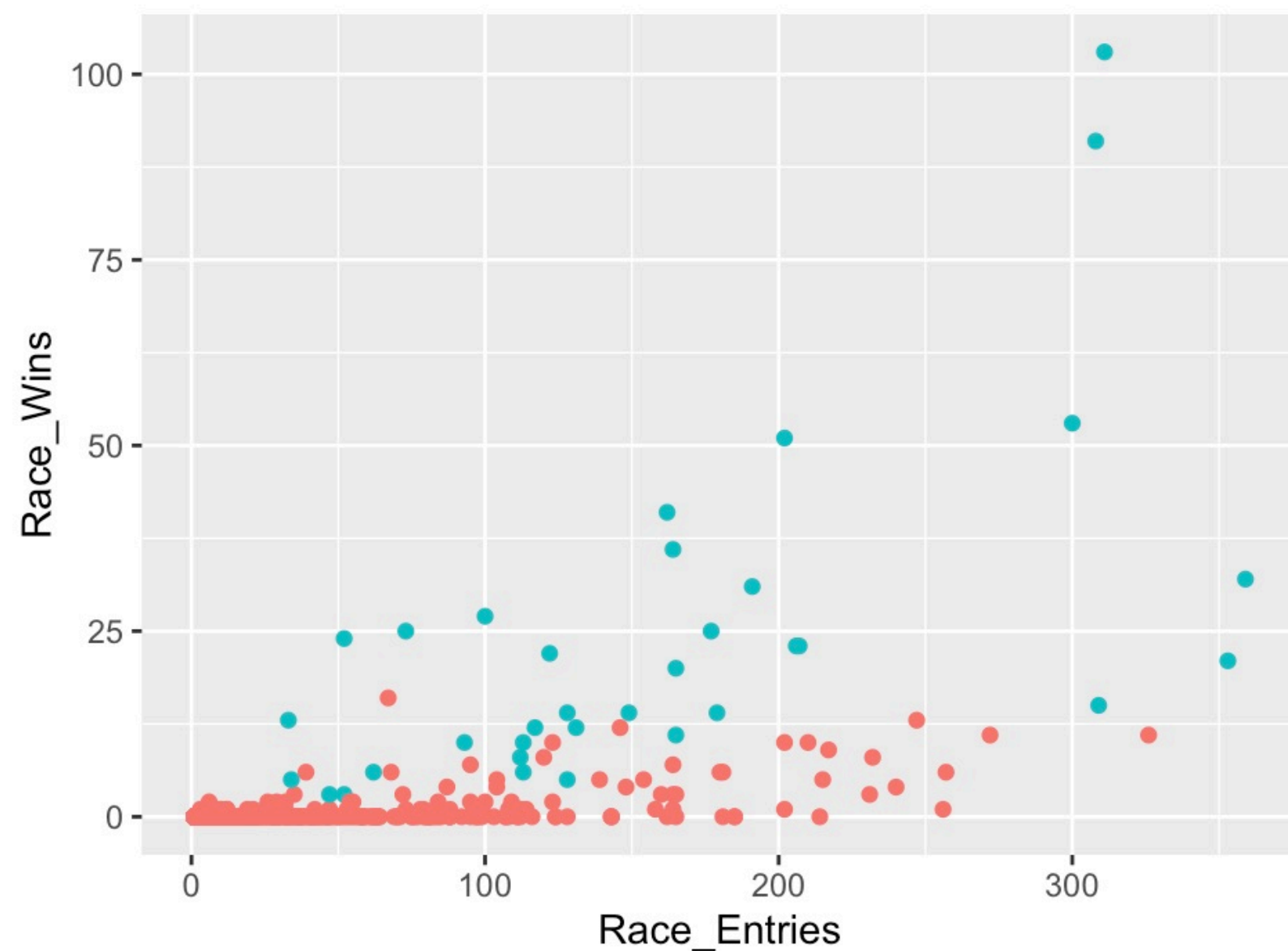
Exploration & Visualization



SCATTERPLOT



Scatterplot - Race Wins vs. Race Entries



Champion

- No
- Yes



Clear Positive Trend

World champions clustered in upper range of both axes

Non-world champions concentrated in zero wins regardless of how many races they enter



Race wins is a strong predictor of championship

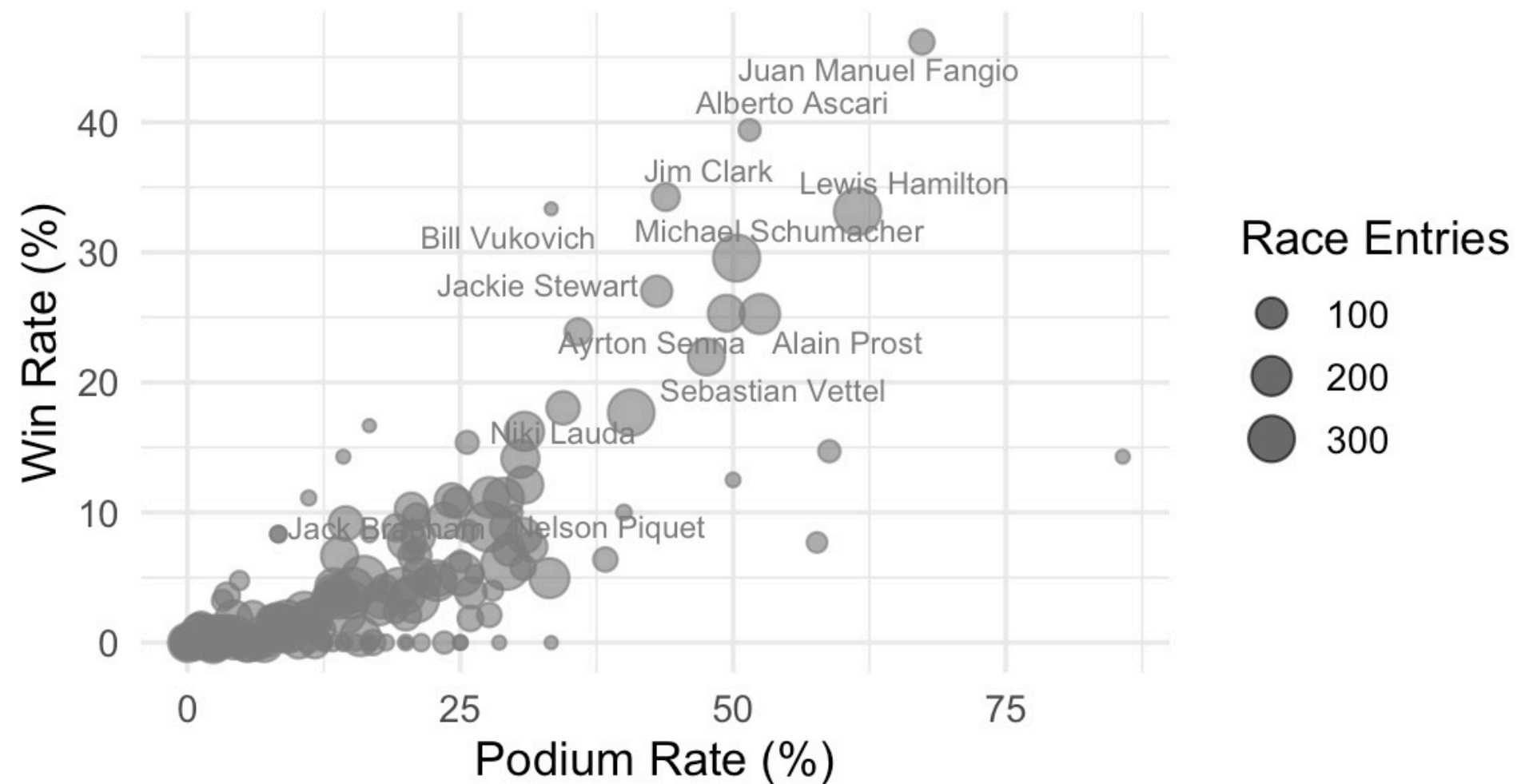
BUBBLE CHART



Bubble Chart - Win Rate vs. Podium Rate

Win Rate vs Podium Rate

Bubble size = total race entries



Champion win rate & podium rate:

16% & 34%

vs.

Non-Champion win rate & podium rate:

1% & 3%



Win rate & podium rate are both strong predictors

Difference in race entries & win rate between early era champions vs. modern era champions

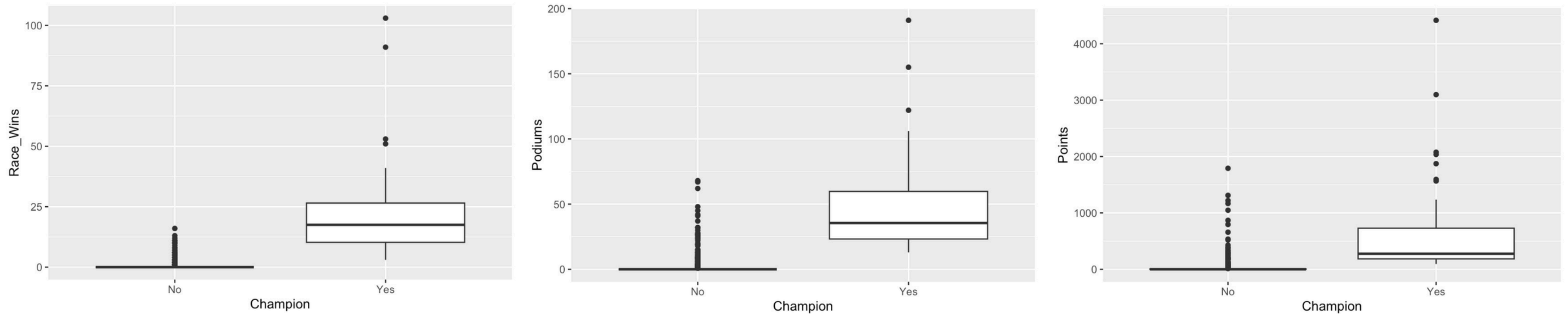


Rate-based metrics accounting for era effects

BOXPLOTS



Boxplots – Race Wins, Podiums, and Points by Champion Status



Champion median

Race wins: 17.5

Podiums: 35.5

Career points: 275.5

0 in all three for non-champion

**Non-champion distributions are heavily right-skewed
→ most drivers have no wins nor podiums**

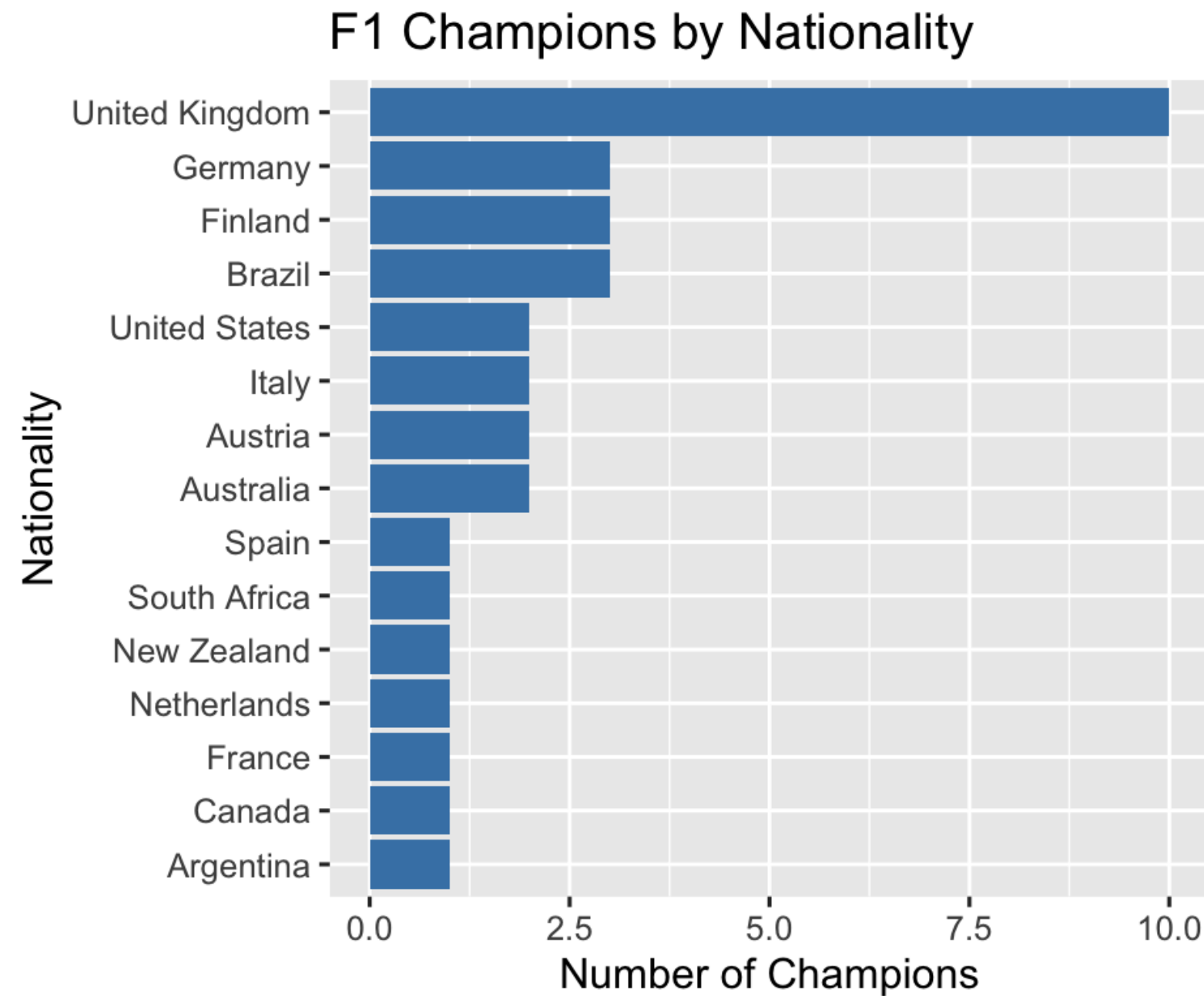
**Significant outliers within non-champion:
Valtteri Bottas - 1,791 points, 10 wins, no championship**



BAR CHART



Bar Chart – F1 Champions by Nationality

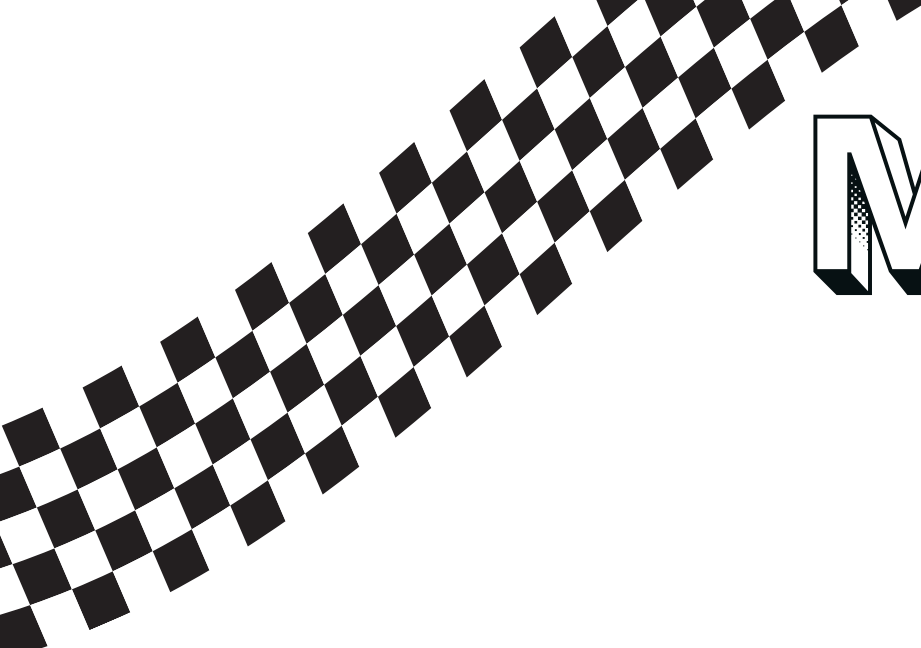


**Provides historical context as
of how geographic and
resource advantages have
shaped driver success**

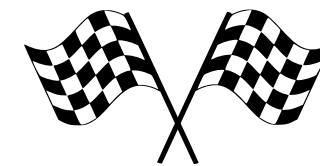
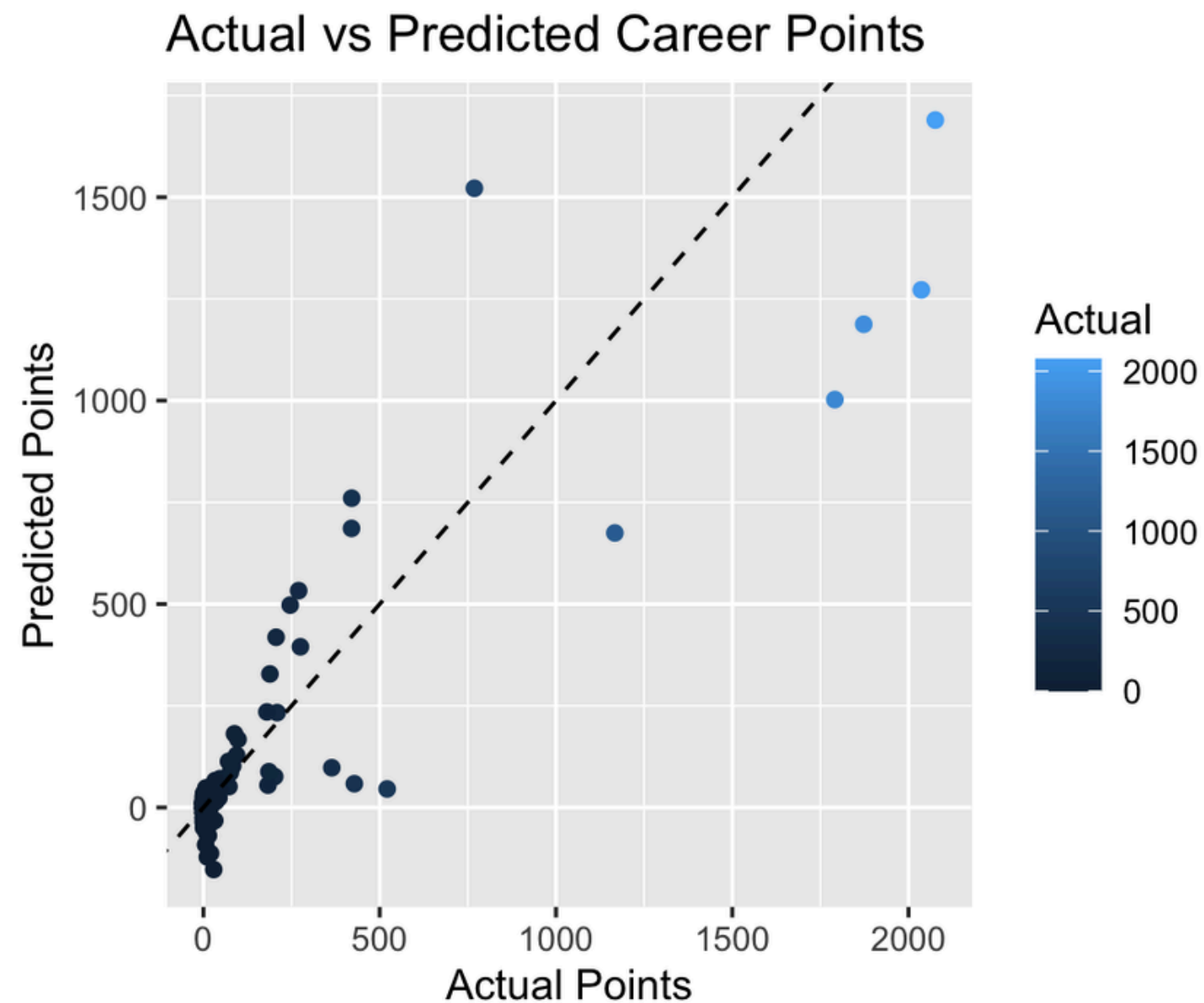
Turn 3

Preprocessing & Mining

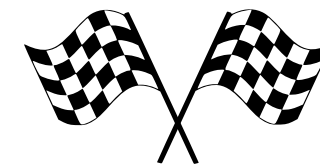




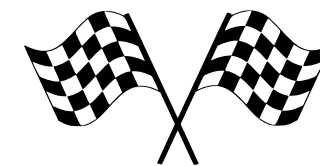
MULTIPLE LINEAR REGRESSION



R-Squared = 0.812



RMSE = 119 and MAE = 42.6



Strongest Predictors

Podiums, Race Entries, Race Wins



MAE better reflects typical driver predictions, as RMSE is inflated by outliers like Hamilton and Schumacher

LOGISTIC REGRESSION



Champion (Yes/No)

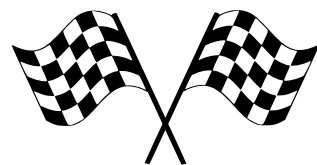


Exclude "Points" Variable



70/30 split, 0.5 cutoff

Key Findings



Race_Wins
Strongest Predictor
(p-value = 0.0032)



Podium_Rate
Marginally Significant
(p-value = 0.0577)

Model Performance

1. **Accuracy = 98.1%**
2. **Sensitivity = 70%**
3. **Specificity = 99.2%**
4. **Kappa = 0.727**

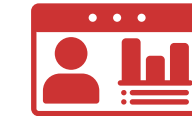
CLASSIFICATION



Champion (Yes/No)

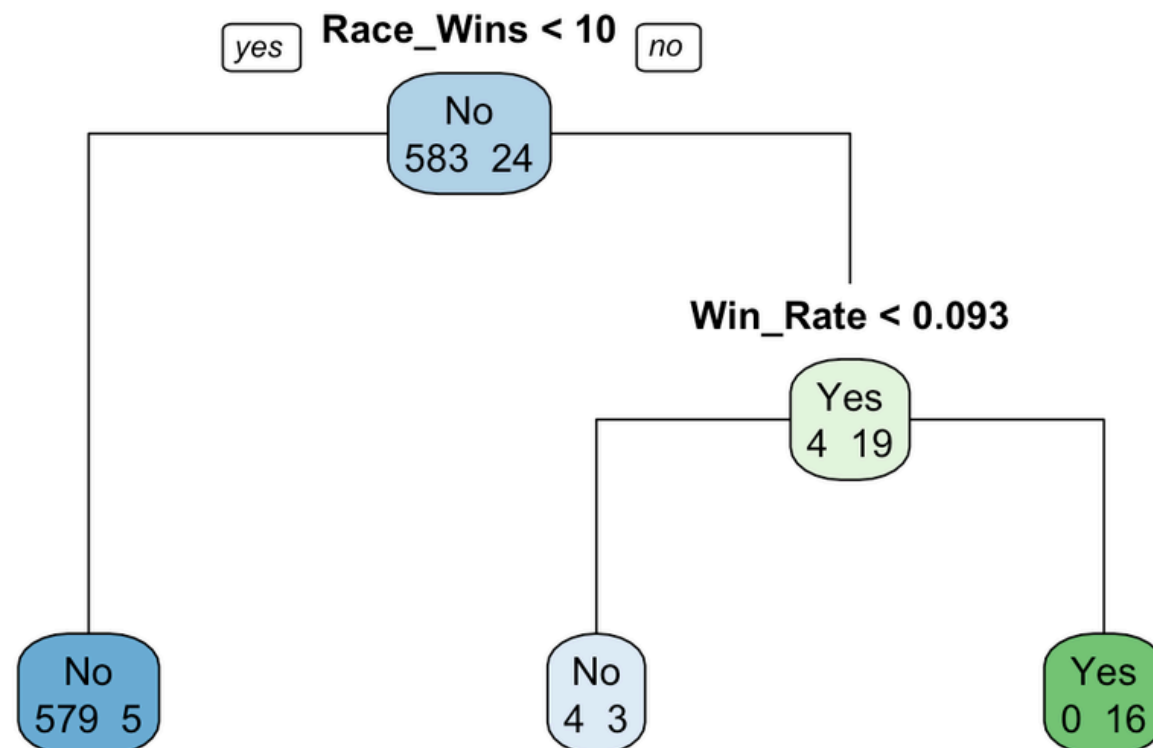


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Classification Tree - F1 Champion Prediction



Data & Purpose

Exploration & Visualization

Preprocessing & Mining

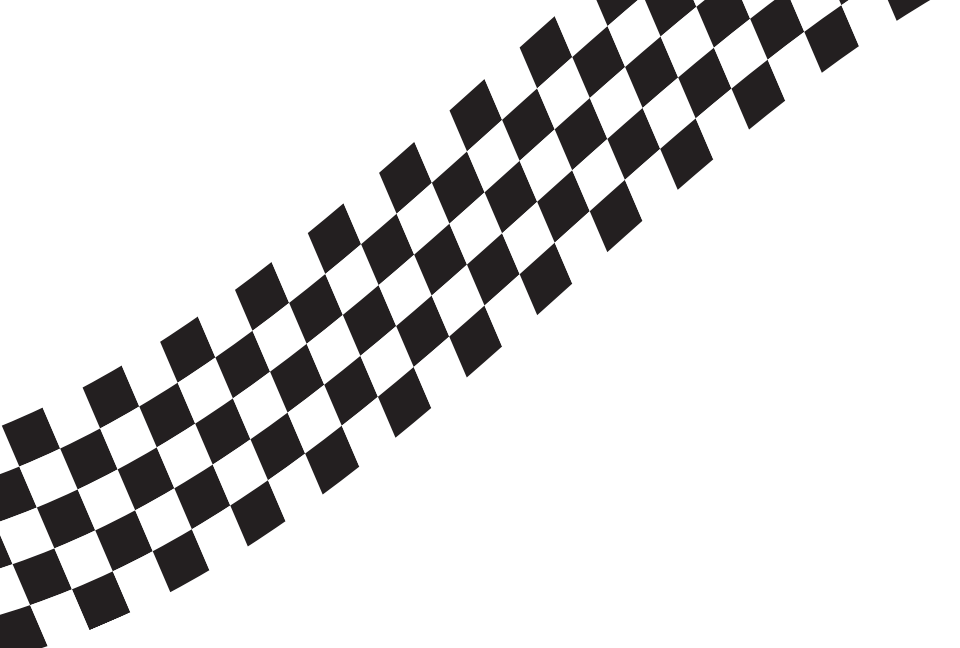
Results & Insights

Model Performance

1. **Accuracy = 97.3%**
2. **Sensitivity = 40%**
3. **Specificity = 99.6%**
4. **Kappa = 0.521**

Key Takeaway

Logistic Regression
outperforms the
classification model on
sensitivity



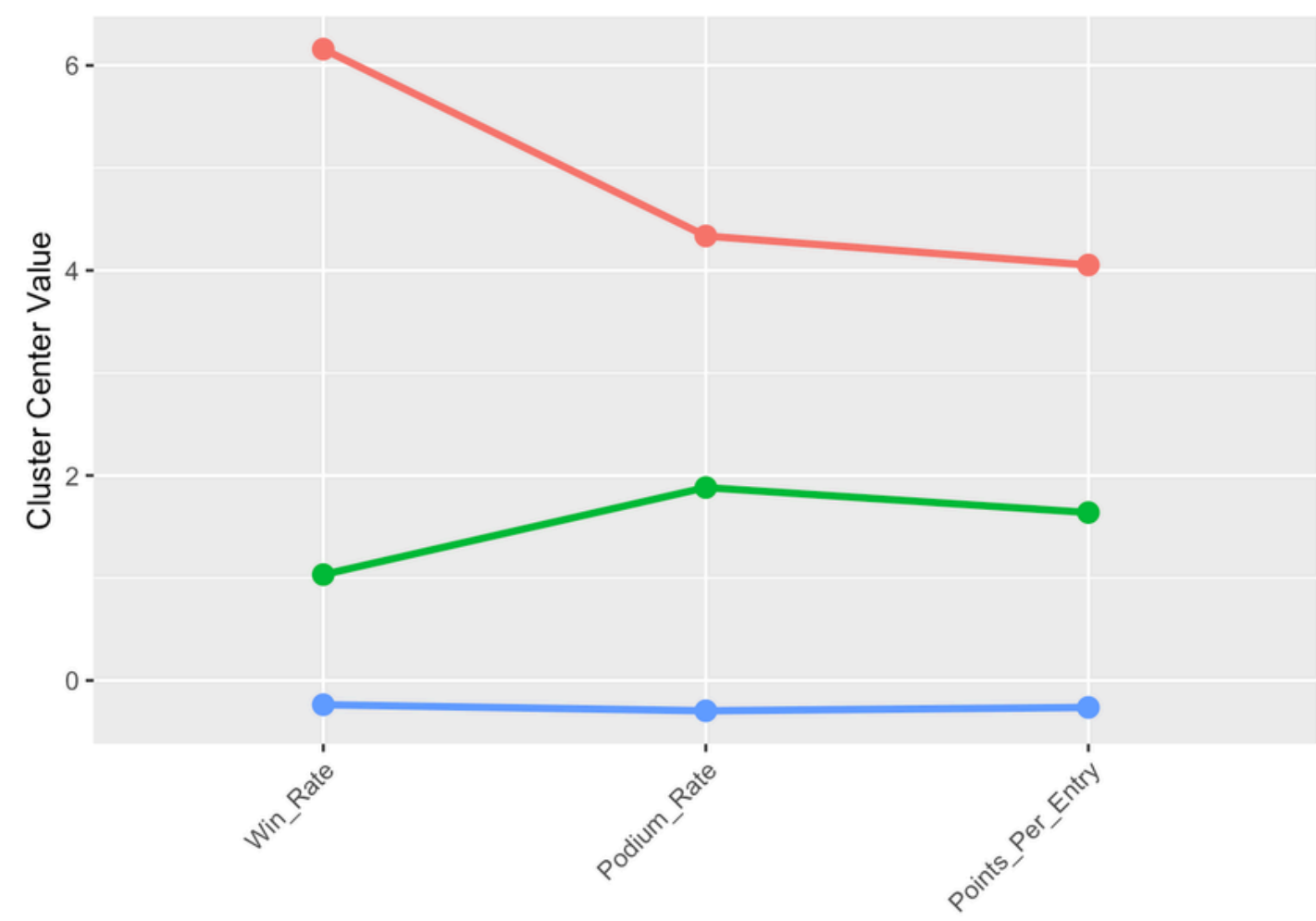
K-MEANS



Win_Rate

Podium_Rate

Points_Per_Entry



Data normalized prior to clustering



Number of clusters (k) = 3



Tier 1

Tier 2

Tier 3

Elite Drivers

Competitive Drivers

Developing Drivers



Turn 4

Results & Insights



RESULTS



Who Benefits From the Data?

- F1 Team Principals and talent acquisition
- Sponsors and commercial partners
- Junior division racing programs

How Would the Data Help Them Make Better Decisions?

- Most important metrics: Podiums, Race_Wins
- Career length, pole position, and race volume are not significant predictors



INSIGHTS



What Other Data Would Be Useful?

- Car performance metrics
- Other variables: championship standings, car performance rating
- Race-by-race records
- Teammate comparisons
- Driver data: debut age, junior series results, salary

INSIGHTS



Obstacles Overcame

1

- Class imbalance in our dataset (Only 34 champions of 868 drivers) → multiple models + sensitivity
- Careful selection of variables to avoid inflating results
- Evaluation of models and model outputs

Future Improvements

2

- Splitting the dataset by time periods to see F1 evolution
- Incorporating automobile performance metrics
- Removing redundant variables and improving class imbalance

Role of AI

3

- Chart aesthetics
- Verify and correct R code
- Context for regression model output

Finish Line
Thank You! Questions?

